transit-aware event discovery for newcomers to Vancouver

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CUXD-111-S001-2026: Product Design Strategy

follow along at **slides.nicojan.com**

Every app she opens recommends stuff she can't afford, can't reach, or doesn't care about.

The gap between "I want to try this" and actually going? That's what **wyd** closes.

meet yuki

Who Is Yuki

🇨🇳 international student from China, studying UX design here in Vancouver

🎨 art, music, snowboarding.

🚌 No car. Bus only. Her brother is why she's here.

🌍 still figuring out what's actually out there

> *I need to know the traffic. How can I go hiking? Is it close or far?*

Yuki, on what stops her from trying new activities

understanding the problem

SEMI-STRUCTURED INTERVIEW · IN PERSON · 30 MIN

Key Findings

Broken Discovery

Eventbrite pushes things she doesn't care about. The stuff she'd actually attend? Buried.

Transit is a Wall.

No app tells her whether she can get there by bus.

Newcomer Friction

What gear? How far? For beginners? Hiking stays on the someday list.

Yuki's Journey Map

PHASE	Trigger	Search	Scroll & Dig	Evaluate Logistics	Decision
DOES	Friday night, wants to go out	opens Eventbrite, types interests	scrolls results, tries filters	checks location, transit, gear	saves or gives up
😖	limited free time	generic recs, nothing relevant	content buried, endless scrolling	no transit info, no distance, no gear help	goes with incomplete info or stays home
👀	onboarding: interests + transit	personalized, interest-matched feed	clearer categories, filter by vibe	transit block: route, time, gear list	save with calendar, share, recs

The Core Tensions

She can't get there.

An art event downtown looks perfect. The listing says "Commercial Drive" and nothing else. Which bus? How long? She closes the app.

and

She wants to but won't.

Hiking keeps coming up. Friends post about it. But no gear, no trail knowledge, no way to get there by bus. So she doesn't go.

problems → product

Jobs to be Done

1

"Tell it who I am."

Set interests, transit mode, goals. The feed should show things worth going to from day one.

2

"Show me what fits."

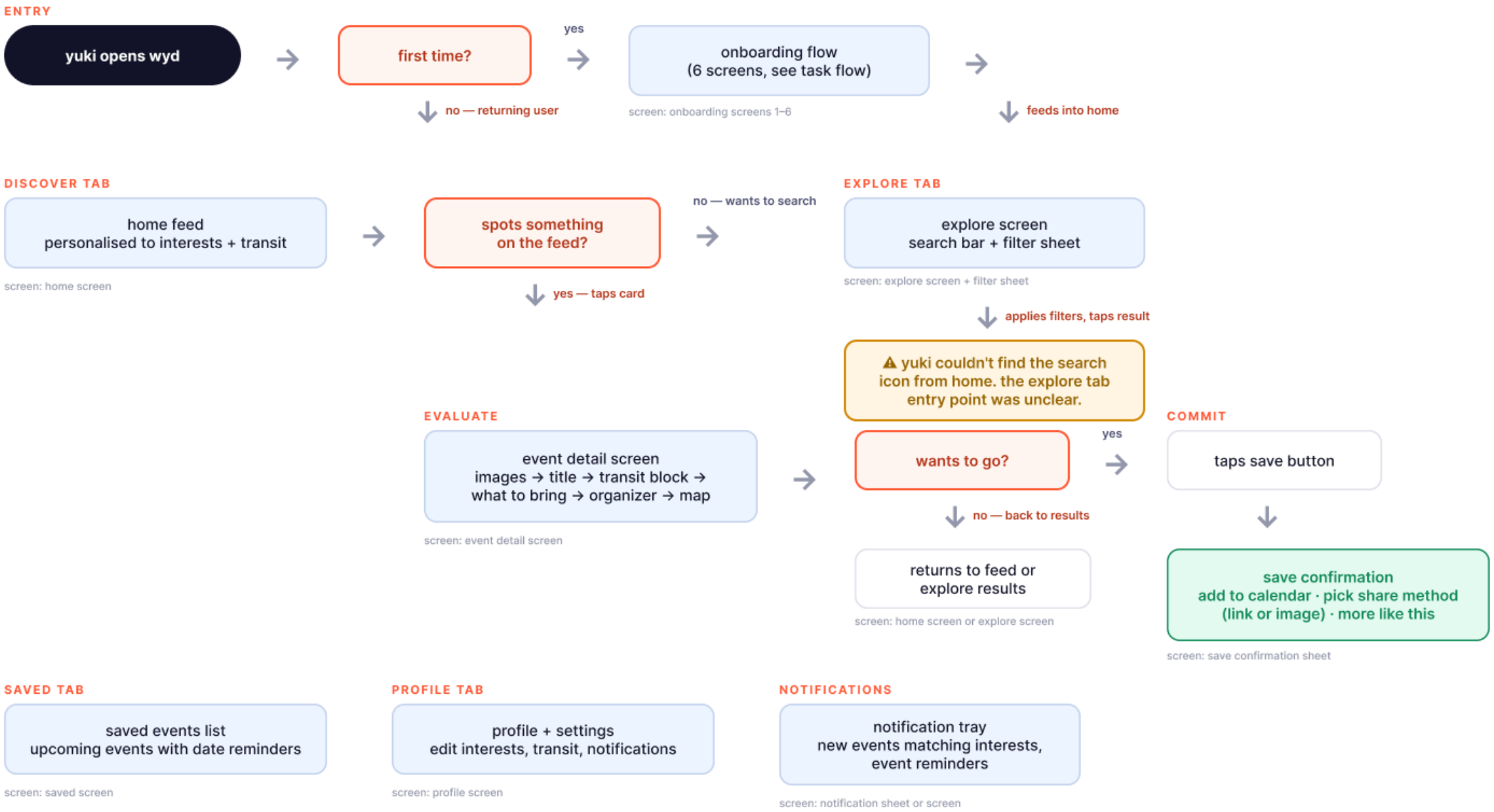
Close, relevant, reachable by bus. More going, less scrolling.

3

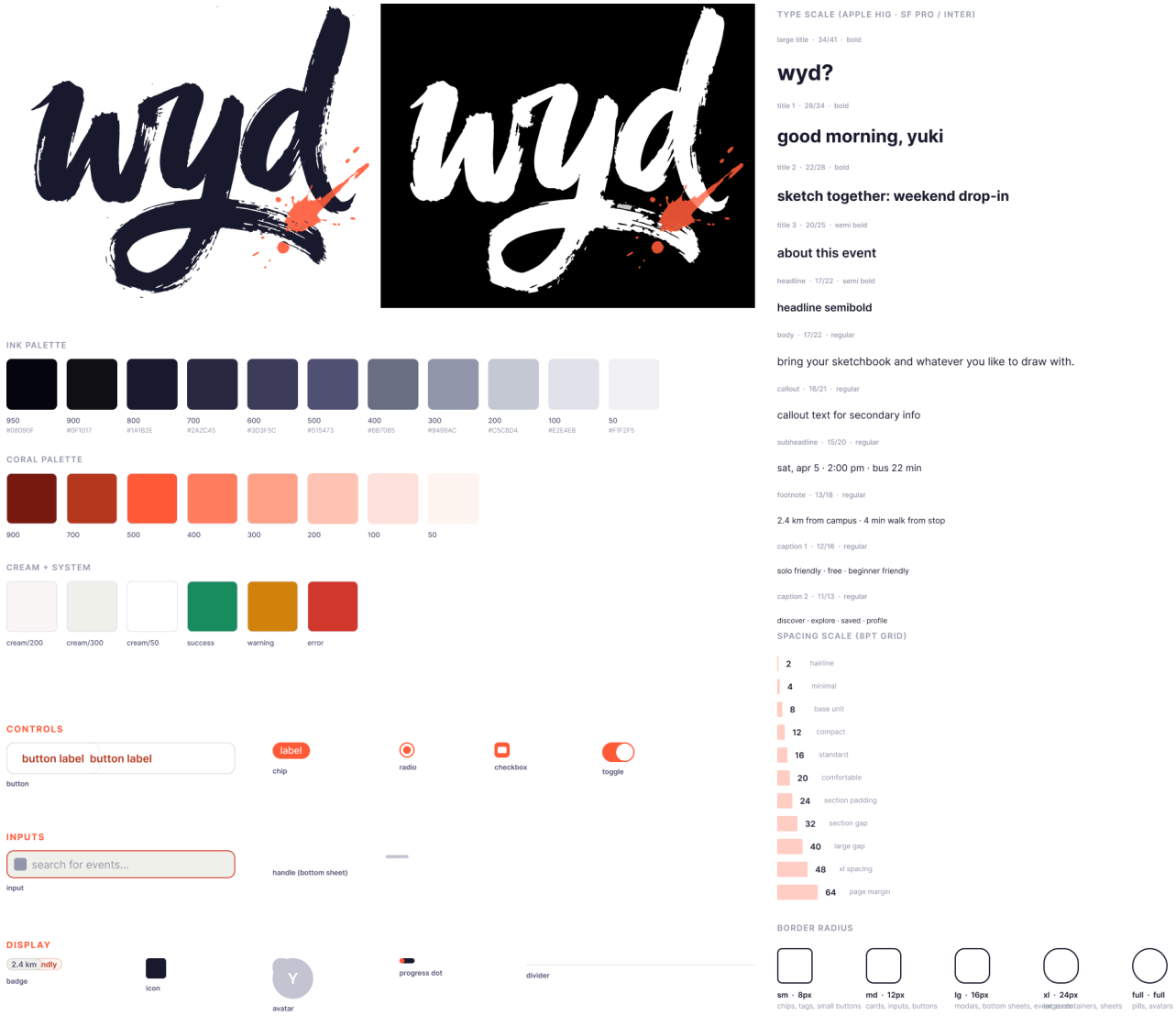
"Help me commit."

Transit directions, duration, what to bring.

User Flow


ENTRY
yuki opens wyd
first time?
yes
onboarding flow
(6 screens, see task flow)
screen: onboarding screens 1–6
no — returning user
feeds into home
DISCOVER TAB
home feed
personalised to interests + transit
screen: home screen
spots something
on the feed?
yes — taps card
no — wants to search
EXPLORE TAB
explore screen
search bar + filter sheet
screen: explore screen + filter sheet
applies filters, taps result
⚠ yuki couldn't find the search icon from home. the explore tab entry point was unclear.
EVALUATE
event detail screen
images → title → transit block →
what to bring → organizer → map
screen: event detail screen
wants to go?
yes
no — back to results
returns to feed or
explore results
screen: home screen or explore screen
COMMIT
taps save button
save confirmation
add to calendar · pick share method
(link or image) · more like this
screen: save confirmation sheet
SAVED TAB
saved events list
upcoming events with date reminders
screen: saved screen
PROFILE TAB
profile + settings
edit interests, transit, notifications
screen: profile screen
NOTIFICATIONS
notification tray
new events matching interests,
event reminders
screen: notification sheet or screen

design + testing



Brand Identity

Powder and Ink.

Ink because she sketches. Powder because she rides. The wordmark is a brush stroke on paper.

Lowercase everything · 4.5:1 contrast · Apple guidelines

Design System

Built from the smallest pieces up. The transit block is the key building block. Event cards, detail screens, save confirmations all use it. One component, tied to shared style values, done.

Three visual modes let the same components serve both prototypes. Light, Dark, Wireframe. One toggle.

127 tokens

12 atoms

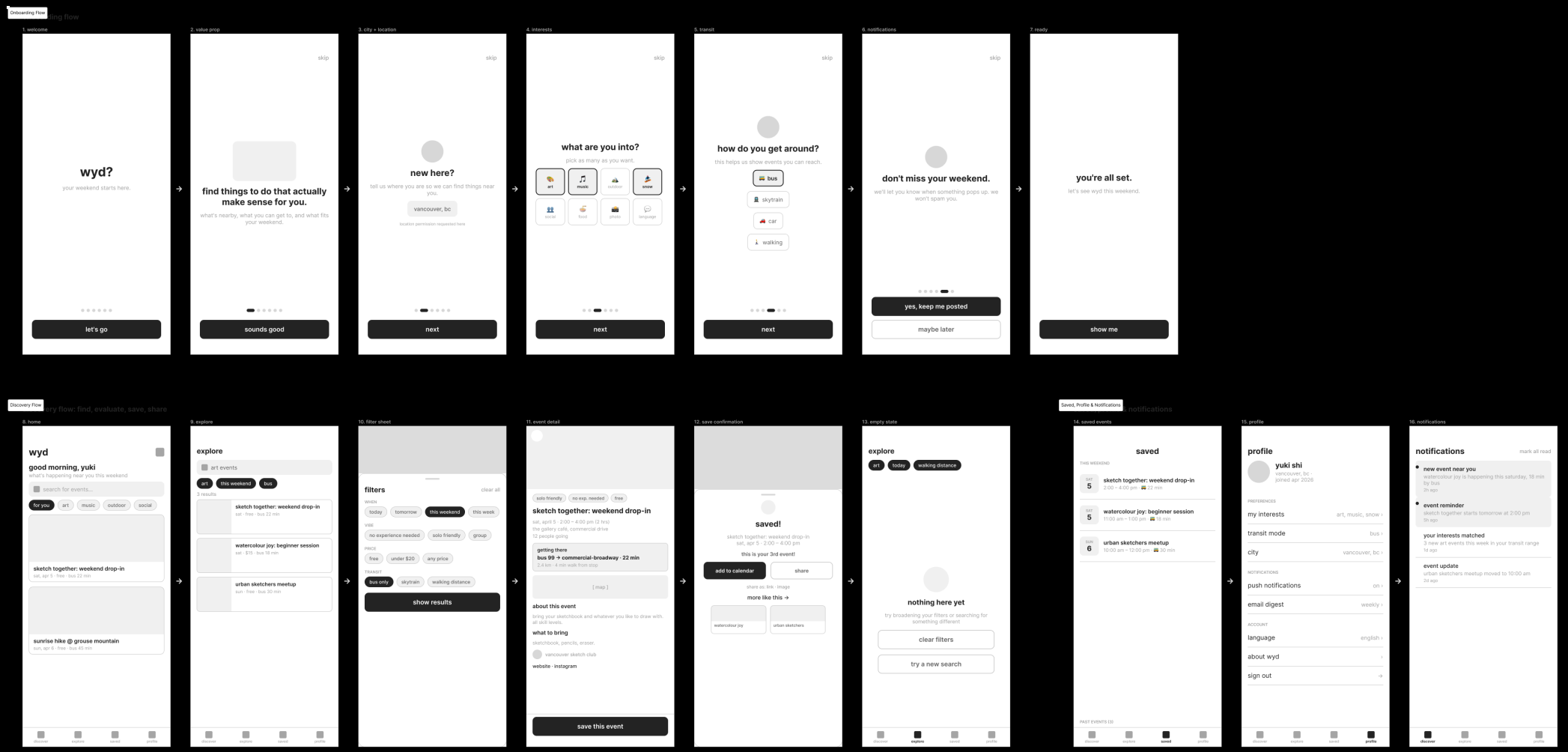
8 molecules

9 organisms

247 bindings

Lo-Fi Wireframes

16 screens · onboarding, discovery, supporting flows



IN-PERSON THINK-ALOUD · 1 PARTICIPANT · LO-FI PROTOTYPE

What Testing Revealed

Lost Search

"I want to search but I don't know where."

Misread Label

She read "beginner friendly" as the app's difficulty level, not the event's.

Post-Save Gaps

"Maybe it says this is your 3rd time joining."

What Changed

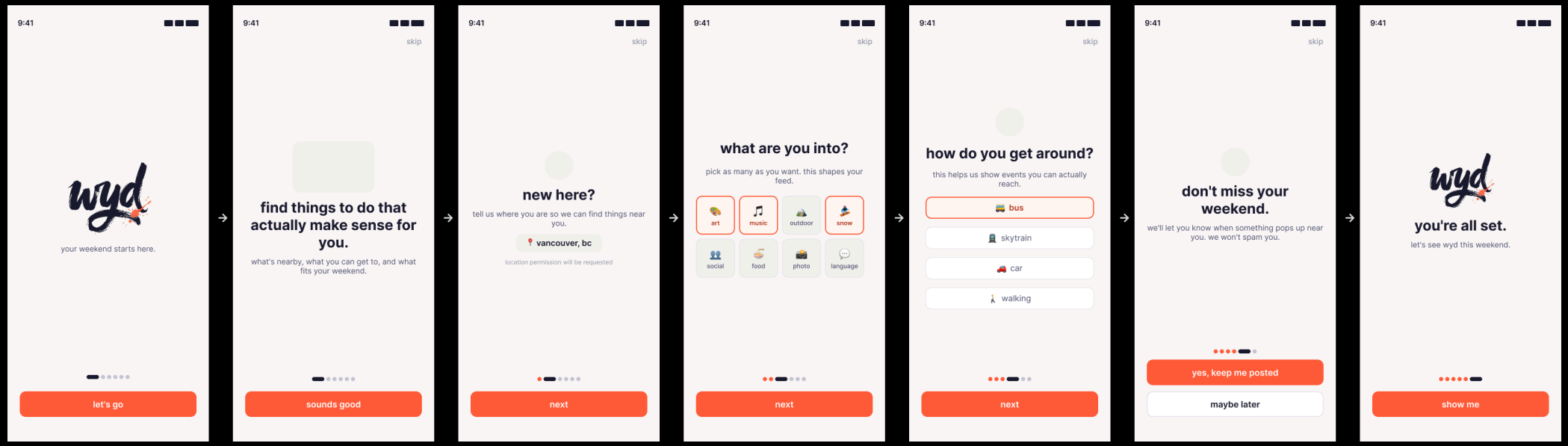
BEFORE		AFTER
Search only on Explore	→	**Search on home too**
"Beginner friendly" buried in filters	→	**Reworded, placed on the card itself**
Save showed name and date	→	**Calendar, share, recs, a small win**
Eight onboarding screens	→	**Six screens with progress dots**

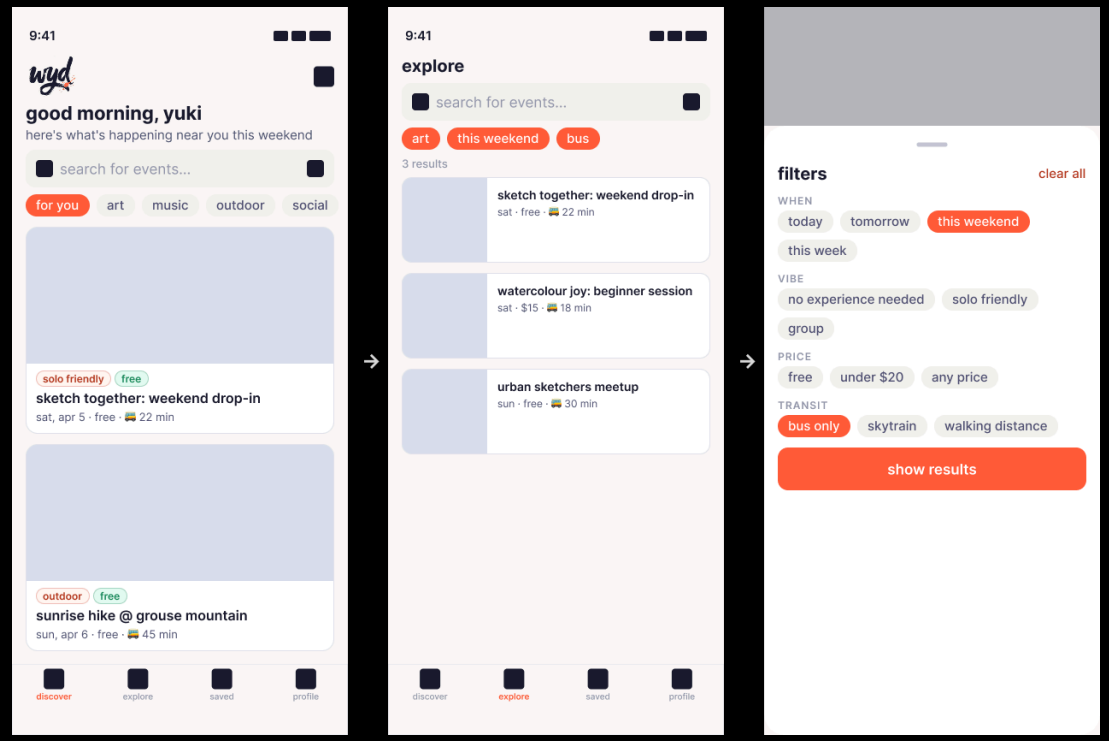
the product

Onboarding

Seven screens. **One ask per screen.**

1. sell the value **2.** welcome her in **3.** earn trust on location and notifications





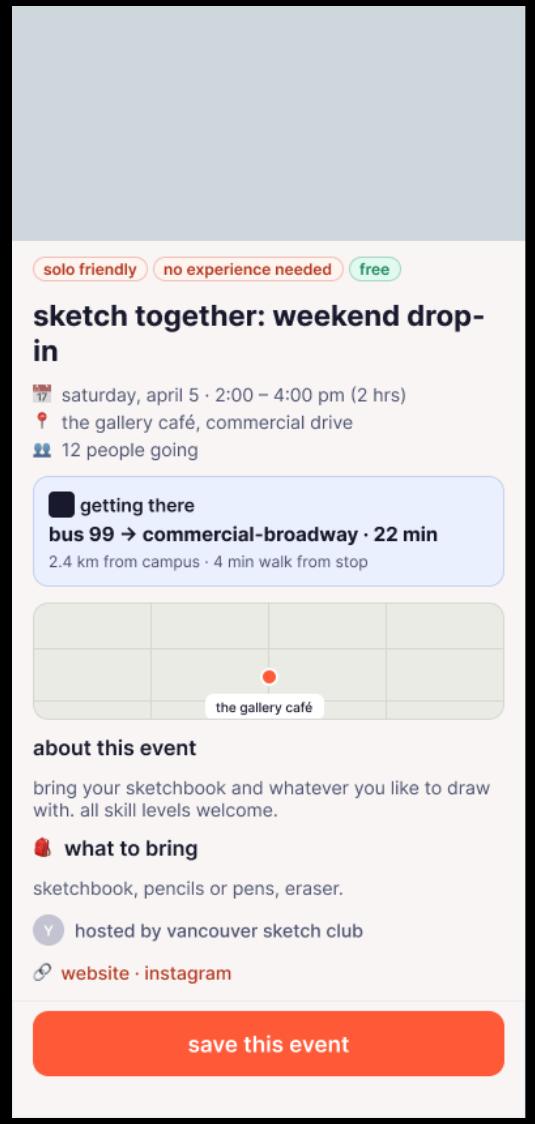
Discover + Explore

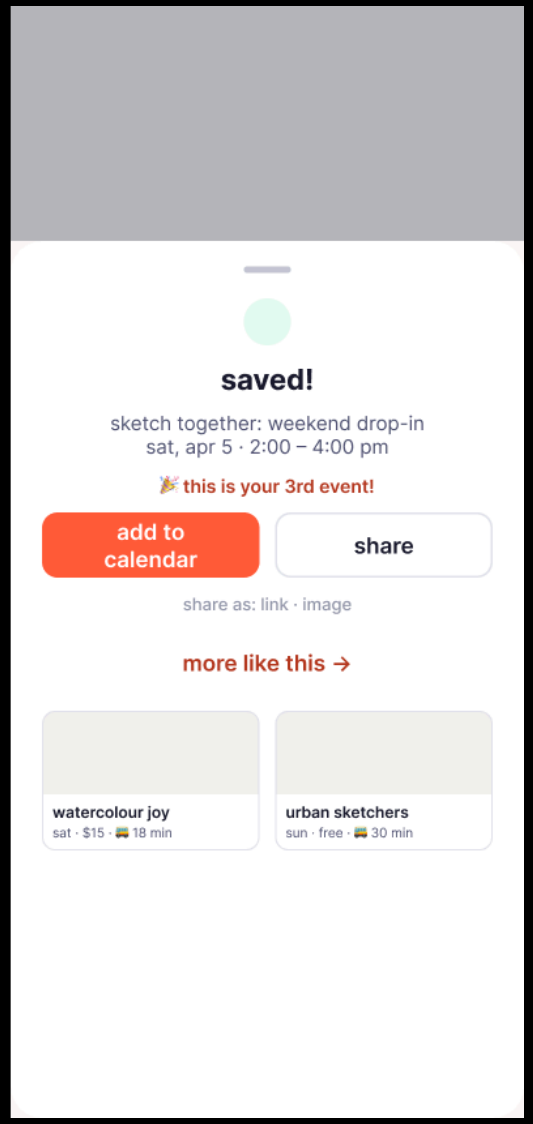
Home is curated. Explore is search. Cards show transit time **at a glance**, so she never has to tap in just to find out she can't get there.

Save + Share

Transit directions, distance, duration, a gear checklist, organizer info, participant count. A map. Not a text address.

After saving: calendar, share, "more like this," and "this is your 3rd event." That last part was her idea.





What wyd Solves

Discovery that Fits

Her feed from day one, not a generic one.

Logistics Up Front

She knows in two seconds if she can get there. No tapping in and backing out.

Interest → Action

Interest turns into a plan.

Next Steps

Calendar Sync

conflict detection before saving

Social

invite friends or match with others

Notifications

keeping the "no spam" promise

Multi-city

rethinking the transit data layer

Broader Audience

anyone new to a place

thank you

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